

Q-Create a comparison table listing at least 5 key differences between traditional WAN and SD-WAN, focusing on how data is routed, managed, and secured.

Feature	Traditional WAN	SD-WAN
1. Data Routing	Traffic usually follows fixed, pre-configured routes through routers.	Traffic is dynamically routed based on application needs, network conditions, and policies.
2. Management	Each router/device is configured and managed individually.	Centrally managed using an SD-WAN controller/orchestrator.
3. Path Selection	Usually depends on static routes or traditional routing protocols such as OSPF, EIGRP, or BGP.	Automatically selects the best available path using real-time network conditions.
4. Security	Security often depends on separate firewalls, VPNs, and security appliances at branch locations.	Security policies can be centrally configured, with features such as encryption, segmentation, and integrated security.
5. Internet Usage	Often relies heavily on expensive private WAN connections such as MPLS.	Can intelligently use multiple links such as MPLS, broadband, and 4G/5G.
6. Configuration	Changes may require manual configuration at multiple branch routers.	Policies can be configured centrally and pushed to multiple branches automatically.
7. Application Awareness	Routing is primarily based on IP addresses and routing information.	Can identify applications and prioritize critical traffic, such as VoIP or video conferencing.
8. Scalability	Adding new branches can require significant manual configuration and deployment.	New branches can be deployed more quickly using centralized configuration and automation.